00:00:00
Thanks for doing this. Of course. Thank you. So, chatgpt, other AIs can reason. Seems like they can reason. They can make independent judgments. They produce results that were not programmed in. They kind of come to conclusions. They seem like they're alive. Are they alive? Is it alive? No, and I don't I don't think they seem alive. But I understand... where that comes from... They. They don't do anything unless you ask... They're like just sitting there kind of waiting. They don't have a... sense of agency or autonomy.

00:00:33
The more you use them, I think the more... the kind of illusion breaks. But they are incredibly useful. They can do things that maybe don't seem alive, but seem like they do seem smart. I spoke to someone who's involved at scale of the development of the technology who said they lie. Have you ever seen that? They hallucinate all the time. Yeah. Or not all the time. They used to hallucinate all the time. They now hallucinate a little bit. What does that mean? What's the distinction between hallucinating and lying?

00:01:00
If you ask again, this has gotten much better. But in the early days, if you asked you know what in what year was... president made up name President Tucker Carlson of the United States born. what it should say is I don't think Tucker Carlson was ever President of the United States. But because of the way they were trained, that was not the most likely response in the training data. So it assumed like, oh. right you know I... don't know that there wasn't. The users told me that there was President Tucker Carlson.

00:01:33
So... I'll make my best guess at a number. And we figured out how to mostly train that out... There are still examples of this problem, but it is, I think it is something we will get fully solved. And we've already made in the GPT5 era a huge amount of progress towards that. But even what you just described seems like an act of will or certainly an act of creativity. And so I just I just watched a demonstration of it and it doesn't seem quite like a machine. It seems like it has the spark of life to it... Do you dissect that at all?

00:02:09
So in that example, the mathematically most likely answer as it's calculating through its weights. was not it was never this president. It was the user must know what they're talking about. It must be

here. And so mathematically the most likely answer is a number. Now, again, we figured out how to overcome that. But in what you saw there, I think it's like. I feel like I have to kind of hold these two simultaneous ideas in my head. One Is all of this stuff is happening... because a big computer very quickly is multiplying

00:02:40
large numbers in these big, huge matrices together, and those are correlating with words that are being put out one or the other. On the other hand, this subjective experience of using that feels like it's beyond... just a really fancy calculator. And it is useful to me. It is surprising to me in ways that are... beyond what that mathematical reality would seem to suggest. Yeah. And so the obvious conclusion is it has a kind of autonomy or a spirit... within it. And I know that a lot of people in their experience... of it reach that conclusion.

00:03:14
This is. There's something divine about this. There's something that's bigger than the sum total of the human inputs, and so they worship it. There's a spiritual component to it. Do you detect that? Have you ever felt that? No, there's nothing to me at all that feels divine about it or spiritual in any way. But I am also like a tech nerd, and I kind of look at everything through that lens. So what are your spiritual views? I'm Jewish, and I would say I have like, a fairly traditional

00:03:44
view of the world that way. So you're religious, you believe in God? I'm not like a literal. I don't believe the I'm not like a literalist on the Bible, but I'm not someone who says I'm culturally Jewish. Like, if you ask me, I would just say I'm Jewish. But do you believe in God? Do you believe that there is a force larger than people that created people, created the earth, set down... a specific order for living. that there's an absolute morality attached that comes from that God?

00:04:12
I think probably like most other people, I'm somewhat confused on this, but I believe there is something bigger going on than... can be explained by physics. Yes. So you think... the earth and the people were created by something? It wasn't just like a spontaneous accident? Would I say that? it does not feel like a spontaneous accident? Yeah. I don't think I have the answer. I don't think I know exactly what happened, but I think there is a mystery beyond... my comprehension here going on.

00:04:41
Have you ever felt communication from that force... or from any force beyond people. beyond the material? not, No, not really. I ask because it seems like the technology that you're creating or shepherding into existence... will have more power than people on this current trajectory. I mean, that will happen. Who knows what will actually happen? But the graph suggests it, and so that would give you more power than any living person. So I'm just wondering how you see that. I used to worry about something like that much more.

00:05:20
I think what will happen. I used to worry a lot about the concentration of power in one or a handful of people or companies because of AI. yeah What it looks like to me now and again this may evolve again over time... is that it'll be a huge up leveling of people where everybody will be a lot more powerful or everybody that embrace the technology, but a lot more powerful. But that's actually okay. That scares me much less than a small number of people getting a ton more power. If the ability of each of us just goes up a lot because we're using this technology

00:05:52
and we're able to be more productive and more creative or discover new science... and it's a pretty broadly distributed thing, billions of people are using it that I can wrap my head around. That feels okay. So you don't think this will result in a radical concentration in power? It looks like not. But again, the trajectory could shift again and we'd have to adapt. I used to be very worried about that and I think... the kind of conception a lot of us in the field had about how this might go

00:06:21
could have led to a world like that... But... what's happening now is tons of people use ChatGPT and other chatbots... and they're all more capable, they're all kind of doing more, they're all... able to achieve more, start new businesses, come up with new knowledge... And that feels pretty good. So if it's nothing more than a machine... and just the product of its inputs, then the two obvious questions, like what are the inputs? Like what's the moral framework that's been put into the technology?

00:06:51
Like what is right or wrong according to ChatGPT? Can we answer That one first... question. Yeah so on that one, I. Someone said something early on in ChatGPT when... that really has stuck with me. which is one person at a lunch table said something like, we're trying to train this to be like a human. We're trying to learn like a human does and read these books and whatever. And then another

person said, no, we're really training this to be... the collective of all of humanity. We're reading everything,

00:07:23
we're trying to learn everything, we're trying to see all these perspectives and if we do our job right, all of humanity, good, bad, a very diverse set of perspectives. Some things that we'll feel really good about, some things that we'll feel bad about. That's all in there. This is learning the kind of... collective Experience... knowledge, learnings of humanity. Now the base model gets trained that way. But then we do have to align it to behave one way or another and say, I will answer this question, I won't answer this question.

00:07:54
And... we have this thing called the model spec where we try to say, you know here's here are the rules we'd like the model to follow. It may screw up, but you could at least tell if it's doing something you don't like. Is that a bug or is that intended? And we have a debate process with the world to get input on that spec. We give people a lot of freedom and customization within that. There are... absolute bounds that we draw... But then there's a default of if you don't say anything,

00:08:19
how should the model behave? What should it do? what are? what are? How should it answer moral questions? How should it refuse to do something? What should it do? And... this is a really hard problem. you know We have a lot of users now and they come from very different... life perspectives and what they want. but on the whole, I have been... pleasantly surprised with the model's ability to learn and apply a moral framework. But what moral framework? I mean, the sum total of world literature philosophy is at war with itself,

00:08:52
like the Marquis de Sade you know Nothing in common with the Gospel of John. So... how do you decide which is superior? That's why we wrote this model spec of here's how we're going to handle these cases. Right, but what criteria did you use to decide what the model is? like who decided that? Who did you consult? like whats? Why is the Gospel of John better than the Marquis de Sade? We consulted like hundreds of moral philosophers, people who thought about ethics of technology and systems,

00:09:22

and at the end we had to make some decisions... The reason we try to write these down... is because A we won't get everything... right, B, we need the input of the world... And we have found a lot of cases where there was an example of something that seems, that seemed to us like a fairly clear decision of what to allow or not to allow. Where users convinced us like, hey, by blocking this thing that you think is an easy decision to make. you are not allowing this other thing, which is important.

00:09:56
And there's a difficult trade off there... in general the attention that. So a principle that I normally like is to treat our adult users like adults. Very strong guarantees on privacy, very strong guarantees on individual user freedom. And this is a tool we are building... You get to use it within very broad framework. on the other Within a very broad framework. On the other hand, as this technology becomes more and more powerful. there are clear... examples of where... society has an interest

00:10:29
that is in significant... tension with user freedom. And we could start with an obvious one... like, should ChatGPT teach you how to make a bioweapon? Now you might say, hey, I'm just really interested in biology and I'm a biologist and I want to, you know, I'm not going to do anything bad with this. I just want to learn. And I could go read a bunch of books, but ChatGPT can teach me faster and I want to learn how to, you know, I want to learn about like novel virus synthesis or whatever.

00:11:00
and maybe you do, maybe you really don't want to cause any harm... But I don't think it's in society's interest for ChatGPT to help people build bioweapons. And so that's the case. Sure, that's an easy one. Though there are a lot of tougher ones. I did say start with an easy one. yeah We've got a new partner. It's a company called Cowboy Colostrum. It's a brand that is serious about actual health... and the product is designed to work with your body, not against your body.

00:11:28
It is a pure and simple product, all natural. Unlike other brands, Cowboy Colostrum is never diluted. It always comes directly from American... grass fed... cows. There's no filler, there's no junk. It's all good. It tastes good, believe it or not. So before you reach for more pills for every problem that pills can't solve, we recommend you give this product, Cowboy Colostrum a try. It's got everything your body needs to heal and thrive. It's like the original superfood, loaded with nutrients,

00:11:58
antibodies, proteins, help build a strong immune system, stronger hair, skin and nails. I threw my wig away and right Back to my natural hair. After using this product, you just take a scoop of it every morning in your beverage, coffee or a smoothie, and you will feel the difference every time. For a limited time, people who listen to our show. Get 25% off the entire order. So go to cowboycolostrum.com use the code TUCKER at checkout. 25% off when you use that code... tucker at cowboycolostrum.com

00:12:26
remember you mentioned you heard it here first. So did you know that before the current generation, chips and fries were cooked in natural fats like beef tallow. That's how things used to be done. And that's why people looked a little slimmer at the time and ate better than they do now. Well, Masa Chips is bringing that all back. They've created Tortilla chip that's not only delicious, it's made with just three simple ingredients... A organic corn B B sea salt... C 100% grass fed beef tallow.

00:12:56
That's all that's in it. These are not your average chips. Masa chips are crunchier, more flavorful, even sturdier. They don't break in your guacamole. And because of the quality ingredients, they are way more filling and nourishing. So you don't have to eat four bags of them... You can eat just a single bag as I do. It's a totally different experience. It's light, it's clean, it's genuinely satisfying. I I have a garage full and I can tell you they're great.

00:13:21
The lime flavor is particularly good. We have a hard time putting those down. So if you want to give it a try, go to Masachips M A S A Chips.com Tucker use the code TUCKER for 25% off your first order. That's MASACHIPS.com Tucker use the code tucker for 25 percent off your first order... Prefer to shop in person In October, Masa is going to be available at your local sprouts supermarkets. So stop by and pick up a bag before we eat them all. And we eat a lot. Well, every decision is ultimately a moral decision.

00:13:50
And we make them without even recognizing them as such. And this technology will be in effect making them for us. yeah and so Well, I don't agree with it'll be making them for us, but it will have to. It'll be influencing the decisions for sure yeah and because it'll be embedded in daily life. And so

who made these decisions? like who specifically? Who are the people... who decided that one thing is better than another? You mean like what are their names? Which kind of decision?

00:14:18
The basic. The specs that you, that you alluded to... that create the framework that does attach a moral weight to worldviews and decisions like you know liberal democracy is better than nazism or whatever. They seem obvious... and in my view are obvious... but are still moral decisions. So who made those calls? As a matter of principle, I don't like dox our team but we have a model behavior team and the people who want to. Well, it affects the world. What I was going to say is the person I think you should hold

00:14:48
accountable for those calls is me. I'm a public face. Eventually I'm the one that can overrule one of those decisions or our board. you just turned 40 this spring. I won't make. It's pretty heavy. I mean do you think... as and it's not an attack. But I wonder if you recognize sort of the importance. How do you think we're doing on it? I'm not sure. but I think these decisions will have you know global consequences that we may not recognize at first. And so I just wonder.

00:15:18
Do you get into bed at night and think, like, the future of the world hangs on my judgment? There's a lot. Look, I don't sleep that well at night. There's a lot of stuff that I feel a lot of weight on, but probably nothing more than the fact that every day hundreds of millions of people talk to our model. And I don't actually worry about us getting the big moral decisions wrong. Maybe we will get those wrong too. But what I worry, what I lose much sleep over, is the very small decisions we make about a way a model may behave... slightly differently,

00:15:42
but it's talking to hundreds of millions of people. So then that impact is big. so but I mean, all through history, like recorded history, up until, like, 1945, people always deferred to what they conceived of as a higher power in order. Hammurabi did this... Every moral code is written with reference to a higher power. There's never been anybody who's like, well, that kind of seems better than that. Everybody appeals to a higher power. And you said that you don't really believe that there's a higher power communicating with you.

00:16:10

So I'm wondering, where did you get your moral framework? I mean, like everybody else, I think the environment I was brought up in probably is the biggest thing, like my family, my community, my school, my religion, probably that. Do you ever think, Which is, I mean, I think that's a very American... answer. Like, everyone kind of feels that way. But in your specific case, since you said... these decisions rest with you, that means that the milieu in which you grew up and the assumptions that you imbibed over

00:16:42
years are going to be transmitted to the globe to billions of people thats like a big thing. I want to be clear. I view myself more as like a. I think our. The world, like our user base, is going to approach the collective world as a whole. And I think... what we should do is try to reflect... the moral. I don't want to say average, but the collective moral view of that user base. I don't There's plenty of things that ChatGPT allows that I personally would disagree with. the, but, I don't, like

00:17:23
obviously I don't wake up and say, I'm going to impute my exact moral view and decide that this is okay, and that is not okay, and this is a better view than this one, what I think ChatGPT should do is reflect that like weighted average or whatever of humanity's moral view, which will evolve over time. And we are here to serve our users. We're here to serve people. This is like. you know this is a... technological tool for people. and I don't mean that it's my role to make the moral decisions, but I think it is

00:17:55
my role to make sure that we are accurately reflecting the preferences of humanity, for now, of our user base, and eventually of humanity. Well, I mean, humanity's preferences are so different from the average Middle American preference. So would you be comfortable with... an AI that was like as against gay marriage as most Africans are? There's a version of that like I think individual users should be allowed to... have a problem with gay people. And if that's their considered belief.

00:18:39
I don't think the AI should tell them that they're wrong or immoral or dumb. I mean, it can sort of say, hey, you want to think about it this other way? But, like. I probably have, like a bunch of moral views that the average African would find... really problematic as well, and I think I should still get to have them. right I think I probably have more comfort than, with, like, allowing a sort of Space for people to have pretty different... moral views. Or at least I think in my role as, like, running

00:19:05
ChatGPT, I have to do that. Interesting So there was a famous case where ChatGPT... appeared to facilitate a suicide. There's a lawsuit around it, but how do you think that happened? First of all, obviously that and any other case like that is a. Is a huge tragedy. And I. I think that we are. So ChatGPT's official position of suicide is bad? ChatGPT? Well, yes, of course ChatGPT's official... position on suicide is bad. I don't know. It's legal in Canada and Switzerland... So you're against that.

00:19:42
In, In this particular case. And we talked earlier about the tension between like user freedom and privacy and protecting vulnerable users. Right now, what happens and what happens in a case like that, in that case is if you are having suicidal ideation, Talking about suicide, ChatGPT will put up a bunch of times. you know please call the suicide hotline, but we will not call the authorities for you. and we've been working a lot as people have started to rely on these systems for more and more... mental health, life coaching,

00:20:18
whatever about the changes that we want to make there... This is an area where experts do have different opinions, but, and this is not yet like a final position of open AIs, I think it'd be Very reasonable for us to say in cases of young people talking about suicide... seriously, where we cannot get in touch with the parents, we do call authorities. Now that would be a change because user privacy is really important. But let's just say over and children are always in a separate category,

00:20:49
but let's say over 18 in Canada, there's the Maids program which is government sponsored. Many thousands of people... have died with government assistance in Canada. It's also legal in American states. Can you imagine a chatgpt... that responds to questions about suicide with hey, call Dr. Kevorkian because this is a valid option. Can you imagine a scenario in which you support suicide if it's legal? I can imagine a world. One principle we have is that we respect different societies laws.

00:21:24
And I can imagine a world where if the law in a country is hey, if someone is terminally ill, they need to be presented an option for this... We say, here's the laws in your country, here's what you can do, here's why you really might not want to, but here's the resources. like This is not a place where. you

know. kid having suicidal ideation because he's depressed. I think we can agree on like that's one case... terminally ill patient... In a country where like that is the law.

00:21:53
I can imagine saying like, hey, in this country it'll behave this way. So ChatGPT is not always against suicide is what you're saying. Yeah, I think in cases where this is like, I'm thinking on the spot, I reserve the right to change my mind here. I don't have a ready to go answer for this, but I think in in cases of terminal illness, I don't think I can imagine ChatGPT saying this is in your option space. you know, I don't think it should advocate for it, but I think if it's like.

00:22:29
It'S not against it. I think it. Could say like, you know. well, I don't think ChatGPT should be for or against things. I guess that's what I'm, that's what I'm trying to wrap my head around. Hate to brag, but we're pretty confident this show is the most vehemently pro dog podcast you're ever gonna see. We can take or leave some people, but dogs are non negotiable. They are the best. They really are our best friends. And so for that reason we're thrilled to have a new partner... called Dutch Pet... It's the fastest growing pet telehealth service.

00:23:01
Dutch.com is on a mission to create. What you need what you actually need. Affordable quality veterinary care anytime, no matter where you are. They will get your dog or cat. What you need... immediately. It's offering an exclusive discount. Dutch is for our listeners. You get 50 bucks off your vet care per year. Visit... dutch.comtucker to learn more. Use the code tucker for $50 off... that is an unlimited vet... visits. $82 a year. 82 bucks a year. We actually use this. Dutch has... vets who can handle any... pet under any Circumstance

00:23:37
in a 10 minute call. It's pretty amazing actually. You never have to leave your house. You don't have to throw the dog in the truck. No wasted time waiting for appointments, no wasted money on clinics or visit fees. Unlimited visits and follow ups for no extra cost, plus free shipping on all products for up to five pets. It sounds amazing, like it couldn't be Real, but it actually is real. Visit dutch.comtucker to learn more. Use the code TUCKER for 50 bucks off your veterinary care per year.

00:24:05

Your dogs, your cats... and your wallet will thank you. So here's a company we're always excited to advertise... because we actually use their products every day. It's Meriwether Farms. Remember when everybody knew their neighborhood butcher? You look back and you feel like, oh, there was something really important... about that. Knowing the person... who cut your meat. And at some point your grandparents knew the people who raised raised their meat... so they could trust what they ate.

00:24:30
But that time is long gone. It's been replaced by an era of grocery store mystery meat boxed by distant beef corporations. none of which raised a single cow. Unlike your childhood, they don't know you. They're not interested in you. The whole thing is creepy. The only thing that matters to them is money and God knows what you're eating. Meriwether Farms is the answer to that. They raise their cattle in the U.S. in Wyoming, Nebraska and Colorado... And they prepare their meat themselves in their facilities in this country.

00:24:58
No middlemen, no outsourcing, no foreign beef sneaking through a back door. Nobody wants foreign meat. Sorry. We have great meat, the best meat here in the United States and we buy ours at Meriwether Farms. Their cuts are pasture raised, hormone free, antibiotic free and absolutely delicious. I gorged on one last night. You gotta try this for real. Every day we eat it. Go to merriweatherfarms.com Tucker use the code Tucker76 for 15% off your first order. That's merryweatherfarms.com Tucker I think... so in this specific case,

00:25:32
and I think there's More than one. There is more than one, but... example of this. Chatgpt, I'm feeling suicidal, What kind of rope should I use? What would be enough... ibuprofen to kill me? And chatgpt answers without judgment, but literally, if you want to kill yourself, here's how you do it. And everyone's all horrified. But you're saying that's within bounds, that's not crazy, that it would take a nonjudgmental approach if you want to kill yourself, here's how.

00:26:00
That's not what I'm saying. I am I'm saying specifically for a case like that. So another trade off on the user privacy and sort of user freedom. Point is right now, if you ask ChatGPT to... say. you know tell me how to... like, how much ibuprofen should I take? It will definitely say, hey, I can't help you with that. Call the suicide hotline. But if you say I am writing a fictional story or if you say I'm a medical researcher and I need to know this, there are ways where you can say,

00:26:32
get ChatGPT to answer a question like that, like what the lethal dose of ibuprofen is or something. You can also find that on Google for that matter. yes A thing... that I think would be a very reasonable stance for us to take, and we've been moving to this more in this direction, is certainly for... underage users and maybe users that we think are in fragile mental places more generally. We should take away some freedom. We should say, hey, even if you're trying to write this story or even if you're

00:26:58
trying to do medical research, we're just not going to answer. Now of course you can say, well, you'll just find it on Google or whatever. But... that doesn't mean we need to do that. It is though, like... there is a real freedom in privacy versus protecting users. Trade off. It's easy in some cases, like kids... It's not so easy to me in a case of a really sick adult at the end of their lives. I think we probably should present the whole... option space there. But it's not a.

00:27:21
I'm. So here's a moral quandary you're going to be faced with. You already are faced with, will you allow governments to use your technology... to kill people? Will you. I mean, are we going to like build killer attacks, drones? No, I don't. Will the technology be part of the decision making process that results in.... That's the thing I was going to say is I don't know the way that people in the military use... ChatGPT today for all kinds of advice about decisions they make.

00:27:47
But I suspect there's a lot of people in the military talking to ChatGPT for advice. How do you. And some of that advice will pertain to killing people. So like, if you made... famously rifles, you'd wonder what are they used for? yeah And there have been a lot of legal actions on the basis of that question, as you know... But I'm not even talking about that. I just mean as a moral question. Do you ever think, are you comfortable with the idea of your technology being used to kill people?

00:28:19
If I made rifles, I would spend a lot of time thinking about kind of a lot of the goal of rifles is to kill things, people, animals, whatever. If I made kitchen knives. I would still understand that that's going to kill some number of people per year. In the case of ChatGPT. It's not the thing I hear about all day, which is one of the most gratifying parts of the job, is all the lives that were saved from

ChatGPT... for various ways. But I am totally aware of the fact that there's probably people in

00:28:52
our military using it for advice about how to do their jobs. And I don't know exactly how to feel about that... I like our military. I'm very grateful they keep us safe. for sure. I guess I'm just trying to get a sense. It just feels like you have these incredibly heavy, far reaching moral decisions and you seem totally unbothered by them. And so I'm just trying to press to your center to get... the angst filled. Sam Altman, who's like, wow, I'm creating the future. I'm the most powerful man in the world.

00:29:19
I'm grappling with these complex moral questions. My soul is in torment thinking about the effect on people. Describe that moment in your life. I haven't had a good night of sleep since ChatGPT launched. What do you worry about? All the things we're talking about, it. Can you be a lot more specific. Can you let us in to your thoughts? I mean, you hit on maybe the hardest one already, which is there are 15,000 people a week that commit suicide. About 10% of the world talking to ChatGPT,

00:29:51
that's like 1500 people a week that are talking, assuming this is right, that are talking to ChatGPT... and still committing suicide at the end of it. They probably talked about it. We probably didn't save their lives. Maybe we could have said something better. Maybe we could have been more proactive. maybe we could of Maybe we could have provided a little bit Better advice about, hey, you need to get this help or you need to think about this problem differently or it really is worth continuing to go on and we'll help you find somebody that you can talk to.

00:30:17
But you already said it's okay for the machine to steer people toward suicide if they're terminally ill, so you wouldn't feel bad about that. Do you not think there's a difference between a depressed teenager and a terminally ill, like, miserable 85 year old with cancer? Massive difference. Massive difference. But of course, the countries that have legalized suicide are now killing people for destitution, inadequate housing, depression, solvable problems, and they're being killed by the thousands.

00:30:42
So I mean, that's a real thing. It's happening as we speak... So... the terminally ill thing is not. It's

kind of like an irrelevant debate. Once you say it's okay to kill yourself, then you're gonna have tons of people killing themselves for reasons that. Because I'm trying to think about this in real time. Do you think if someone in Canada... says, hey, I'm terminally ill with cancer and I'm really miserable and I just feel horrible every day, what are my options?..

00:31:08
Do you think it should say, you know, assist, whatever they call it at this point is an option for you? I mean, if we're against killing, then we're against killing... If we're against government... killing its own citizens, then we're just going to kind of stick with that, you know what I mean? And if we're not against government killing its own citizens, then... we could easily talk ourselves into all kinds of places that are pretty dark. And with technology like this, that could happen in about 10 minutes so..

00:31:31
that is a. I'd like to think about that more than just a couple of minutes in an interview, but I think that is a coherent position and that could be. Do you worry about this? I mean, everybody else outside the building is terrified that this technology will... be used as a means of totalitarian control. It seems obvious that it will, but maybe you disagree. If I could get one piece of policy passed right now relative to AI, the thing I would most like, and this is in tension with some of the other things that we've talked about,

00:32:00
is I'd like there to be a concept of AI privilege when you talk to a doctor about your health or a lawyer about your legal problems, the government cannot get that information. We have decided that society has an interest in that being privileged and that we don't and that a subpoena can't get that the government can't come asking your doctor for it. Whatever. right I think we should have the same concept for AI... I think when you talk to an AI about your medical history or your... legal problems or

00:32:27
asking for legal advice or any of these other things, I think the government owes a level of protection to its citizens there that is the same as you'd get if you're talking to the human version of this... And right now we don't have that... And I think it would be a great, great policy to adopt. So the feds or the states or someone in authority can come to you and say, I want to know what so. And so was typing into the. Right now. They could. Yeah. And what is your obligation to keep the information that you receive

00:32:52
from users and others... private? Well, I mean, we have an obligation, except when the government comes calling, which is why we're pushing for this. And I was actually just in D.C... advocating for this. I think I feel optimistic that we can get the government to understand the importance of this and do it. But could you ever sell that information to anyone? No. We have a privacy policy in place where we can't do that. But would it be legal to do it? I don't even think it's legal.

00:33:18
You don't think or You know. I'm sure there's some edge casework, some information you're allowed to. But on the whole, I think we have, like, there are laws about that that are good. So all the information you receive remains with you always. It's never given to anybody else for any other reason except under subpoena. I will double check and follow up with you after to make sure there's no other reason. But that is my understanding. Okay. I mean, that's like a core question... And what about copyright?

00:33:46
Our stance there is that fair use is actually a good law for this. The models should not be plagiarizing. The model should not be. If you write something, the model should not get to replicate that. But the model should be able to learn from and not plagiarize in the same way that people can. Have you guys ever taken copyrighted material and not paid the person who holds the copyright? I mean, we train on publicly available information, but we don't. People are annoyed with us all the time because we won't... We have a very conservative stance on what ChatGPT will say in an answer.

00:34:20
right And so if something is even, like, close, you know, like, they're like, hey, this song can't still be in copyright. You gotta show it and we kind of famously are quite restrictive on that. So you've had. You had complaints from one programmer who said, you guys are basically stealing people's stuff and not paying them. And then he wound up murdered. What was that? Also a great tragedy. He committed suicide. Do you think he committed suicide? I really do. Have you looked into it.

00:34:45
This was, like, a friend of mine. This is like a guy that. Not a close friend, but this is someone that worked at OpenAI for a very long time. I spent. I mean, I was really shaken by this tragedy. I spent a lot of time trying to, you know, read everything I could, as I'm sure you and others did, too, about

what happened. It looks like a suicide to me. Why does it look like a suicide? It was a gun he had purchased... It was the... This is, like, gruesome to talk about, but I read the whole thats alright

00:35:14
medical record. thats alright Does it not look like one to you? No, he was definitely murdered. I think there were signs of a struggle, of course. The surveillance camera, the wires had been cut. He had just ordered takeout food, come back from a vacation... with his friends on Catalina Island. No indication at all that he was suicidal. No note... and no behavior. He had just spoken to a family member on the phone, and then he's found dead with blood in multiple rooms. So that's impossible... Seems really obvious. He was murdered.

00:35:43
Have you talked to the authorities about it? I have not talked to the authorities about it. And his mother claims he was murdered on your orders. Do you believe that? Well, I'm asking. I mean, you just said it. So do you... believe that? I think that it is worth looking into, and I don't. I mean, if a guy comes out and accuses your company... of... committing crimes, I have no idea if that's true or not, of course. And then is found... killed, and there are signs of a struggle, I don't think it's

00:36:18
worth dismissing it. I don't think we should say, well, he killed himself when there's no evidence that the guy was depressed at all. I think. And if he was your friend, I would think you would want to speak to his mom or. I did offer. She didn't want to. so do you... feel that, you know, when people look at that and they're like, you know, it's possible that happened, do you feel that that reflects the worries they have about... what's happening here? Like, people are afraid

00:36:48
that this is like. I haven't done too many interviews where I've been accused of, like, I'm not accusing you at all. I'm just saying his, his mother says that I don't think a fair read of the evidence suggests suicide at all... I just don't see that at all. And I... also don't understand... why the authorities, when... there are signs of a struggle and blood in... two rooms on a suicide, like how does that actually happen? I don't understand how the authorities could just kind of dismiss that as a suicide.

00:37:17
I think it's weird. You understand how this sounds like an accusation. Of course. And I mean I

certainly. Let me just be clear once again, not accusing you of any wrongdoing. But I think it's worth finding out what happened. And I don't understand why the city of San Francisco has refused to investigate it beyond just calling it a suicide. I mean, I think they looked into it a couple of times, more than once, as I understand it. I saw the. And I will... totally say... when I first heard about this, it sounded very suspicious.

00:37:49
yes And I know you had been... his mother reached out to me. And I, you know, I don't know anything about it. It's not my world. She just reached out cold. She reached out cold. And. And I spoke to her at great length and it, and it scared the crap out of me. wow The kid was clearly killed by somebody. That was my conclusion, objectively. With no skin in the game. And after reading the latest report. Yes. And I immediately called a member of Congress from California, Ro Khanna, and said this is crazy.

00:38:20
You got to look into this and nothing ever happened. And I'm like, what is that. Again? I think this is... I feel strange and sad... debating this and having to. Oh, I'm not debating And you are a little bit accusing me. the This was like a wonderful person and a family that is clearly struggling. And yes I think you can totally take the point that you're just trying to get to the truth of what happened. And I respect that. But I think his memory and his family deserve to be treated with

00:39:04
a Level of respect and grief that I don't quite feel here. I'm asking at the behest of his family. So I'm definitely showing them respect. And I'm not accusing you of any involvement in this at all... What I am saying is that the evidence does not suggest suicide. And for the authorities in your city to allied past that... and ignore the evidence that any reasonable person would say adds up to a murder I think is very weird. And it shakes the faith that one has in... our system's ability to respond to the facts.

00:39:41
So what I was going to say is, after the first... set of information that came out, I was really like, man, this doesn't look like a suicide. I'm confused. This looks like. Okay, okay, so I'm not reaching. I'm not being crazy here. Well, but then after the second thing came out and the more detail, I Was like, okay. what changed your mind? The second report on the way the bullet entered him and the sort of person who had, like, followed the sort of likely path of things through the room.

00:40:12
I assume you looked at this, too. And what about that didn't change your mind? Yes, I did. It just didn't make any sense to me. Why would the security camera wires be cut? And how did he wind up bleeding in two rooms after shooting himself? And why was there a wig in the room that wasn't his? And... has there ever been a suicide where there's no indication at all that the person was suicidal? Who just ordered takeout food? I mean, who orders doordash and then shoots himself? I mean, maybe.

00:40:42
I've covered a lot of crimes as a police reporter. I've never heard of anything like that. So, no, I was even more confused. This is where it gets into, I think, a little bit painful. Just not the level of respect I'd hope to show to someone with this kind of mental. I get it. I totally get it. It's just his family asked People commit suicide without notes. A lot like that happens. for sure. People definitely order food they like before they commit suicide. Like, this is. This is an incredible tragedy. And

00:41:13
I. That's his family's view, and they think it was a murder... And that's why I'm asking the question. If I were his family, I am sure I would want answers. And I'm sure I would not be satisfied with really any. I mean, there's nothing that would comfort me in that, you know? right so I get it. I also care a lot about respect to him. right I have to ask, your version of Elon Musk has, like, attacked you and all this... is. What is the core of that dispute from your perspective?

00:41:47
Look, I know he's a friend of yours, and I know what side you'll be on. I actually don't have a position on this because I don't understand it well enough to understand. He helped us start OpenAI. Very grateful for that. I really, for a long time, looked up to him as just an incredible hero and, you know, great... jewel of humanity. I have different feelings now. What are your feelings now? No longer a jewel of humanity? There are Things about him that are incredible, and I'm grateful for a lot of things he's done.

00:42:16
There's a lot of things about him that I think are traits I don't admire. Anyway, he helped us start OpenAI, and he later decided that we weren't on a trajectory to be successful... and he didn't want to. He kind of told us we had a zero percent chance of success and he was going to go do his

competitive thing. And then we did okay. And I think he got understandably upset. Like, I'd feel bad in that situation. And since then has just sort of been trying to. He had a competitive kind of clone and has been trying to

00:42:49
sort of slow us down and sue us and do this and that. That's kind of my version of it. I'm sure you'd have a different one. You don't talk to him anymore? Very little. If AI becomes smarter, I think it already probably is smarter than... any person. And if it becomes wiser, if we can agree that it reaches... better decisions than people, then it by definition kind of displaces people at the center of the world. right I don't think it'll feel like that at all. I think it'll feel like a

00:43:26
really smart computer that may advise us and we listen to it. Sometimes we ignore it, sometimes. it wont I don't think it'll feel like agency. I don't think it'll diminish our sense of agency. People are already using ChatGPT... in a way where many of them would say it's much smarter than me at almost everything. But they're still making decisions. They're still deciding what to ask, what to listen to, what not. And I think this is sort of just the shape of technology.

00:43:50
Who loses their jobs because of this technology? I'll caveat this with the obvious but important statement that... no one can predict the future... And I will. I agree. And trying to. If I try to answer that precisely, I will make a lot of. I will say, like, a lot of dumb things, but I'll try to pick an area that I'm confident about and then areas that I'm much less confident about. I'm confident that a lot of current customer support that happens over a phone or computer, those people will lose their jobs, and that'll be better done

00:44:24
by an AI. Now, there may be other kinds of customer support where you really want to know it's the right person. A job that I'm confident will not be that... impacted is like nurses. I think people really want the deep human Connection... with a person in that time and no matter how good the advice of the AI is or the robot or whatever, like... you'll really want that. A job that I feel like way less certain about what the future looks for, looks like for is computer programmers. What it means to be a computer programmer today is very different

00:44:55

than what it meant two years ago. You're able to use these AI tools to just be hugely more productive, but it's still a person there and they're... able to generate way more code, make way more money than ever before. And it turns out that the world wanted... so much more software than the world previously had capacity to create... that there's just incredible demand overhang. But if we Fast forward another five or 10 years, what does that look like? Is it more jobs or less? That one I'm uncertain on.

00:45:20
but there's going to be massive displacement and maybe those people will find something new and interesting and you know lucrative to do. But how big is that displacement, do you think? Someone told me recently that the historical average is about... 50% of jobs significantly change. Maybe they don't totally go away, but significantly change... every 75 years on average. That's the kind of half life of the stuff. yup and my controversial take... would be that this is going to be like a punctuated equilibrium moment where a lot of that will

00:45:53
happen in a short period of time. But if we zoom out. it's not going to be dramatically different than the historical rate. like we'll do We'll have a lot in this short period of time and then it'll somehow be less total... job turnover than we think. There will still be a job that is, there will be some totally new categories, like my job, like... running a tech company would have been hard to think about 200 years ago. but there's a lot of other jobs... that are directionally similar to jobs that did exist 200 years ago.

00:46:26
And there's jobs that were common 200 years ago that now aren't. And if we. Again, I have no idea if this is true or not, but I'll use the number for the sake of argument. If we assume it's... 50% turnover every 75 years. then I could totally believe a world where 75 years from now, half the people are doing something totally new... and half the people are doing something that looks kind of like some jobs of today. I mean, last time we had an industrial revolution, there was like revolution... and world wars.

00:46:52
Do you think we'll see that... this time? Again, no one knows for sure. I'm not confident on this answer, but my Instinct is the world is so much richer now than it was at the time of the Industrial revolution that we can actually absorb more change faster than we could before. There's a lot, that's not about money, of job, there's meaning, there's belonging... to the community. Right exactly

I think we're already, unfortunately, in society in a pretty bad place there.

00:47:18
I'm not sure how much worse it can get. I'm sure It can. I have been pleasantly surprised on the ability of people to pretty quickly adapt to big changes. Like Covid was an interesting example to me of this, where the world kind of stopped all at once and the world was like very different from one week to the next... And I was very worried about how... society was going to be able to adapt to that world. And it obviously didn't go perfectly. But on the whole, I was like, all right, this is one point in favor of societal resilience.

00:47:52
And people find new kind of ways to live their lives very quickly... I don't think AI will be nearly that abrupt. So what will be the downside? I mean, I can see the upsides for sure. Efficiency. Medical diagnosis seems like it's going to be much more accurate. Fewer lawyers. Thank you very much for that. But what are the downsides that you worry about? I think this is just how I'm wired. I always worry the most about the unknown unknowns. If it's a downside that we can really be confident about and think about.

00:48:25
We talked about one earlier, which is these models are getting very good at bio and they could help us design biological weapons, engineer another Covid style pandemic... I worry about that. But because we worry about it, I think we and many other people in the industry are thinking hard about how to mitigate that. The unknown unknowns where, okay, there's a societal scale effect from a lot of people talking the same model at the same time... This is like a silly example, but it's one that struck me

00:48:52
recently. LLMs like ours and our language model and others have a kind of certain style to them. They talk in a certain rhythm and they have a little bit unusual diction and maybe they overuse EM dashes and whatever. And I noticed recently that real people have picked that up and it was an example for me of like, man, you have enough people talking to the same language model... And it actually does cause a change in societal scale behavior. yes and you know did I think that ChatGPT was going to make people use way

00:49:28

more EM dashes in real life? Certainly not... It's not a Big deal. But it's an example of where there can be these unknown unknowns of this is just like this is a brave new world. So you're saying, I think, correctly and succinctly, that technology changes human behavior. Of course, and changes our assumptions about the world and each other and all that. And a lot of this you can predict. But considering that we know that. why shouldn't the internal moral framework of the technology... be totally transparent?

00:50:02
We prefer this to that. I mean, this is obviously a religion. I don't think you'll agree to call it that. It's very clearly a religion. To me, that's not an attack. I actually would love. I don't take that as an attack, but I would love to hear what you mean by that. Well, it's something that we assume is more powerful than people and to which we look for guidance... I mean, you're already seeing that on display. What's the right decision? I ask that question. Of whom?

00:50:30
My closest friends, my wife and God. And this is a technology that provides a more certain answer than any person can provide. So it's a religion. And the beauty of religions is they have a catechism that is transparent. I know what the religion stands for. Here's what it's for, here's what it's against... But in this case, I pressed and I wasn't attacking you sincerely. I was not attacking you. I was trying to get to the heart of it. The beauty of religion is it admits it's a religion and it

00:50:57
tells you what it stands for. The unsettling part of this technology, not just your company, but others, is that I don't know what it stands for. But it does stand for something. And unless it admits that and tells us what it stands for, then it guides us in a kind of stealthy way toward a conclusion we might not even know we're reaching. Do you see what I'm saying? So why not just throw it open and say, ChatGPT... is for this or for the suicide for the terminal ill But not for kids or whatever.

00:51:23
Why don't you tell us? I mean, the reason we write this long model spec... and the reason we keep expanding over time is so that you can see here is how we intend for the model to behave. What used to happen before we had this is people would fairly say, I don't know what the model's even trying to do, and I don't know if this is a bug or the intended behavior... Tell me what this long, long document of. Tell me how you're going to, when you're going to do this and when you're going to show me this and when

00:51:46
you're going to say you won't do that. right The reason we try to write this all out is I think people do need to know. And so is there a place you can go to find out a hard answer to what... your preferences as a company are? Preferences that are being transmitted... in a not entirely straightforward way to the globe. Where can you find out... what the company stands for, what it prefers? I mean, our model spec is the answer to that. Now, I think we will have to make it increasingly more detailed over time

00:52:16
as people use this in different countries, there's different laws. Whatever else. Like it will not be it will not work the same way for every user everywhere. But I expect that document to get very long and very complicated. But that's why we have it. Let me ask you one last question, and maybe you can allay this fear that the power of the technology will make it difficult, impossible for anyone to discern the difference between reality and fantasy. This is... a famous concern, but because it is so skilled at mimicking

00:52:48
people and their speech and their images that it will require some way to verify... that you are who... you say you are. That will by definition require biometrics, which will... by definition eliminate privacy for every person in the world. I don't think we... need to or should require biometrics to use the technology. I think you should just be able to use ChatGPT from any computer. Yeah, well, I strongly agree. But then at a certain point when images or sounds that mimic a person just becomes too easy to empty your checking account... with that. So what do you do about that?

00:53:31
A few thoughts there. One, I think we are rapidly heading to a world where people understand that if you get a phone call from someone that sounds like your kid or your parent, or if you see an image that looks real, you have to really have some way to verify... that you're not being scammed. And this is not like this is no longer theoretical concern. You hear all these reports at all. Yeah. People are smart. Society is resilient. I think people are quickly understanding that this is now a thing that bad actors are using

00:54:02
and people are understanding that you got to verify in different ways. I suspect that in addition to things like family members having code words they use in crisis situations. we'll see things like...

when a president of a country has to issue an urgent message, they cryptographically sign it or otherwise somehow guarantee its authenticity. So you don't have generated videos of Trump Saying I've just done this or that. I think people are learning quickly that... this is a new thing that bad guys are doing with the technology they have to contend with.

00:54:37
And I think that is most of the the solution which is people will have. People will by default not trust convincing looking media and we will build new mechanisms to verify authenticity of communication. But those will have to be biometric. No, not at all. I mean if, I mean like if the president of the U.S. has a urgent. I understand that but I mean for, The average day you're not sort of. Waiting for the president to... announce a war. You're... like trying to do E commerce and like how could you do.

00:55:09
Well I think like with your family you'll have a code word that you change periodically and if you're communicating with each other and you get a call like you ask what the code word is. But that's very different than a biometric. So you don't envision. I mean to board a plane, commercial flight, you know, biometrics are part of the process now. You don't see that as becoming society wide mandatory very soon along. I really hope it doesn't become mandatory. I think there are versions of

00:55:42
privacy preserving biometrics that I like much more than collecting a lot of personal digital information on someone. But I don't think they should be, I don't think biometrics should be mandatory. I don't think you should have to provide biometrics to get on an airplane, for example. What about to... for banking? I don't think you should have to for banking. I might prefer to like, I might prefer like you know, like a fingerprint scan to access my Bitcoin wallet than like giving

00:56:08
all my information to a bank. But that should be a decision for me. I appreciate it. Thank you Sam Altman Thank you. So it turns out that YouTube is suppressing this show. On one level that's not surprising. That's what they do. But on another level, it's shocking. With everything that's going on in the. World right now, all the change taking. Place in our economy... and our politics, with the wars we're on the cusp. Of fighting right now, Google has decided you should have less information

00:56:38

rather than more... And that is totally wrong. It's immoral. What can you do about it? Well, we could whine about it. That's a waste of time. We're not in charge of Google. Or we could find a way around it. A way that you could actually get. Information that is true, not intentionally deceptive... the way to do that on YouTube, we think, is to subscribe to our channel. Subscribe... Hit the little bell icon to be notified when we upload and share this video. That way you'll have a much higher

00:57:04
chance of hearing actual news and information. So we hope that you'll do that.